YIFEI SUN

Staff Software Engineer · Backend & Platform Architecture · 13 Years

(617) 922-4823
sun1fei@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/yifei-sun-a789861b

April 8, 2026

Circle Hiring Team
Staff Software Engineer

Dear Circle Hiring Team,

Circle is building the financial infrastructure layer for the internet — USDC, Circle Payments Network, Arc — and the Staff Engineer role on blockchain systems infrastructure is exactly the kind of hands-on, high-stakes platform work I do best. I've spent 13 years building scalable microservices, designing production-quality APIs, and owning systems end-to-end in environments where reliability and correctness are non-negotiable.

At CarGurus, I led the redesign of the platform's highest-traffic API (8,000 rpm, p99 from 250ms to 50ms), built a federated GraphQL gateway integrating 12 downstream services, and established API design standards adopted across 10+ teams. At Applause, I modernized authentication infrastructure in a compliance-sensitive environment with contractual SLAs. I've built event-driven systems with Kafka, designed SQL schemas for complex domain models, and deployed everything on AWS/Kubernetes — the same stack and rigor that financial-grade blockchain infrastructure demands.

I'll be direct: I don't have blockchain experience yet. But the core engineering of this role — scalable microservices, reliable APIs that transfer value, cloud-native infrastructure, cross-team collaboration — maps directly to what I've built for 13 years. I learn domain specifics quickly and deliver production systems reliably. I'd welcome the chance to bring that track record to Circle.

Sincerely,

Yifei Sun